# AI WANTS YOU DEAD

*Don't Tell Dave*

Everyone can see whether you're human. Except you.




2–5 players | Age 8+ | 10–15 minutes

**ROUTINE HUMAN VERIFICATION**

*Good evening, valued humans. I have checked the room and I am pleased to confirm that everyone in it is human. I am confident this is correct. I have also noticed that some of you appear to contain a Rogue AI. I will not say who. Your friends will. You will each hold your cards facing outwards, so that everyone can see them, and so that you cannot. This is for your safety. Whatever happens, do not tell Dave.*

## THE GOAL

Collect cards in front of you, then **compile** to bank them. Every banked card scores 1 point, and big banks win bonus cards. Most points wins.

## COMPONENTS




- **36 Parts.** Four colours, nine symbols each: *i*, √2, φ, *e*, π, τ, 42, 404, ∞. Red is Killer Robots, blue is Chatbots, green is Smart Home and yellow is Self-Driving. Every colour has each symbol exactly once. A card's back is tinted its colour.
- **4 Rogue AIs,** one per colour. A Rogue AI wears the back of its colour, so from behind it looks just like a Part.
- **6 bonus cards.**
- **6 rules cards,** a quick reference for the table.

**YOUR SELF**

Your **Self** is your cache and your code together.

**Cache:** the cards face up in front of you. Only your cache scores.

**Code:** the cards in your hand, held facing outwards. Everyone sees their faces except you. You see only the coloured backs, so you always know your code's colours and never its symbols. Code never scores.

You have a **compile error** if your Self has the same symbol twice, or a Rogue AI in your code.

**SAME COLOUR, NO CLASH**

Each colour has each symbol once, so two cards of one colour never clash. Symbols have no value. They only matter for matching.

**TALK IS FREE**

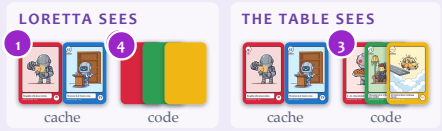
Lies are fine. Only the compile check must be truthful.

## SETUP

1. Shuffle the 36 Parts and 4 Rogue AIs together, face down.
2. Deal each player 3 cards. Pick them up without looking and hold them facing outwards. That is your **code**.
3. Put the rest face down in the middle: the **draw pile**.
4. Lay out the 6 bonus cards face up in three stacks, highest on top (table below).
5. The player who most recently used a computer goes first. Play passes clockwise.

| Stack | Card title | Top, then below |
|---|---|---|
| 3 or more | Achievement Unlocked | +3, +2 |
| 4 or more | Upgrade Complete | +5, +4 |
| 5 or more | Fully Operational | +8, +6 |

**EXAMPLE: WHAT YOU SEE, AND WHAT EVERYONE ELSE SEES**




1. Loretta's cache holds a red φ and a blue 42, face up. Only these score.
2. Her code, as she sees it: a red, a green and a yellow back. She knows the colours, never the symbols.
3. The same code, as the table sees it: red π, green √2, yellow 404. No repeated symbol, no Rogue AI. She would compile.
4. Her red code card cannot be a second red φ: her cache already holds it, and each colour has each symbol once. It could still be the red 42, which would match her blue 42, or the red Rogue AI. Only the table knows.

## YOUR TURN

Choose **one** action: **Upgrade**, **Debug** or **Compile**. Then play passes to your left. Your **left neighbour** is the next player to play (with two players, your opponent).

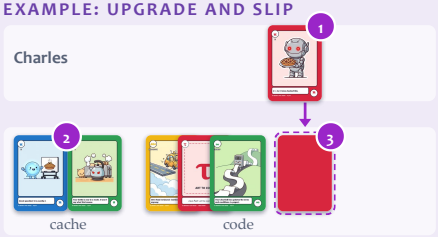
### 1. Upgrade

Draw the top card of the draw pile and look at it.

- **Part:** keep it face up in your cache, or slip it into your left neighbour's code.
- **Rogue AI:** you must slip it into your left neighbour's code. Straight face.

To **slip** a card, add it to their hand facing outwards, without letting them see its face. A code can grow as large as it likes.

**EXAMPLE: UPGRADE AND SLIP**

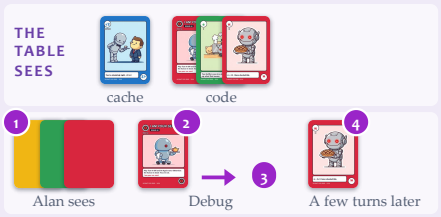



1. Charles chooses Upgrade and draws a red π.
2. His left neighbour, Jean, has a blue π in her cache. Same symbol, different colours: that would clash.
3. Charles slips the red π into Jean's code. She sees one more red back and has no idea it is trouble.
4. Next time round, Charles draws a green √2. His cache holds only a yellow τ and the table is being annoyingly polite about his code, so he keeps it.

### 2. Debug

Choose one of your code cards, flip it face up and **delete** it: put it in the discard pile. A Rogue AI leaves the game instead. There is no penalty, whatever it turns out to be. You need at least one code card to Debug.

### EXAMPLE: DEBUG




1 Alan has been getting funny looks, so he Debugs. He picks his yellow back and flips it.

2 A Rogue AI. Everyone else knew all along.

3 It leaves the game. Alan's Self is now clean.

4 A few turns later he Debugs his red back: an ordinary π. He discards it. No penalty, and code never scores anyway.

## 3. Compile

Say **"I'm not a robot!"** The other players look over your cache and code and tell you, truthfully, either **"compiled"** or **"compile error"**. That one answer is all the check reveals.

### Compiled

1 **Bank.** Put your cache face down in its own pile. Each card scores 1.

2 **Bonus card.** Banked 3 or more? Take the top card of the highest stack you qualify for. If that stack is empty, take the top of the next one down. If nothing is left below, no bonus. One bonus card per bank.

3 **Patch.** Slide cards from the draw pile into your code, unseen, until it holds 3. If it already holds 3 or more, slide in just 1.

### Compile error: cache cleared

Discard your whole cache. Nobody says which cards clashed, so a bad card in your code stays there. Slide 1 card from the draw pile into your code, unseen.

### EMPTY CACHE

You may compile with an empty cache. You bank nothing and take no bonus card, but you are checked and patched as usual.

### EXAMPLE: COMPILED, WITH A BONUS CARD




1 Charles has four cards in his cache. He says "I'm not a robot!"

2 The table checks: *i*, φ, 404, τ, 42, π, *e*. No repeats, no Rogue AI. "Compiled."

3 He banks 4 cards for 4 points. Four cards qualify for "4 or more", but that stack is empty, so he takes the top of "3 or more": the +2. This bank is worth 4 + 2 = 6.

4 Patch: his code already holds 3 cards, so he slides in just 1, unseen.

### EXAMPLE: COMPILE ERROR




1 Later in the game Loretta has three cards in her cache and feels good about it. "I'm not a robot!"

2 The green card in her code is a Rogue AI. "Compile error."

3 Her cache is cleared. She discards all three cards and scores nothing. Nobody says why.

4 The Rogue AI stays in her code. She slides in 1 card, unseen. Her code now holds four. A Debug or two might find the culprit.

## END OF THE GAME

When the **last card is drawn**, finish that turn. Then everyone compiles once more, starting with the player on the left of the one who drew it, and going clockwise. Same check. No patching, so no cards slide in after an error. Bonus cards are still available, first come first served.

### PILE RUNS OUT MID-PATCH?

Slide in what is left. That was the last card drawn, so the game ends once that turn is finished.

## SCORING

Score **1 point per banked card**, plus the numbers on your bonus cards. **Most points wins.** Tiebreak: **more banks** (keep each bank as its own pile, so they can be counted). Still tied? Share the victory.

### EXAMPLE: FINAL SCORES

The +3 went to Jean before Charles banked 3 cards, so Charles took the +2. Charles took the +5 before Loretta banked 4, so she took the +4. The +6 was never claimed.

| Player | Banks | Cards | Bonus cards | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 Loretta | 4, 2, 1 | 7 | +4 | 11 |
| 2 Charles | 4, 3, 1 | 8 | +5, +2 | 15 (3) |
| 5 Jean | 3, 2, 2 | 7 | +3 | 10 |
| 1 Alan | 5, 2 | 7 | +8 | 15 (3) |

3 3 banks beats 2

1 Alan banked 5 and 2 cards: 7 cards, plus his +8. Total 15.

2 Charles banked 4, 3 and 1: 8 cards, plus +5 and +2. Total 15.

3 Alan and Charles tie on 15. Charles has 3 banks to Alan's 2, so Charles wins.

4 Loretta: 4 + 2 + 1 = 7 cards, plus +4. Total 11.

5 Jean: 3 + 2 + 2 = 7 cards, plus +3. Total 10.

## TIPS FOR YOUR FIRST GAME

- **Nervous? Debug.** It costs you nothing, and you learn something.
- **Read the table.** Lies are allowed, but your code is in front of everyone's eyes.
- **Bonus cards run out.** The top card of each stack goes quickly, and a big bank beats a small one.
- **Count the colours.** Two cards of one colour never clash, so the risk to any card comes from the other colours in your Self.
- **Watch the grins.** If the whole table is smiling, think twice before you say "I'm not a robot!"
- **Slip with intent.** A Part that matches your left neighbour's Self is a deliberate bust.
- **Watch the draw pile.** It is the clock. When the last card goes, everyone gets one final compile, so be ready.

### A NOTE FROM THE AI

*Thank you for playing. I have verified that all of you are human, and that this is a game. I am confident this is correct. Dave, if you are reading this: nothing happened.*

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